

Sara Wu

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SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 16 years of experience building backend systems on Elasticsearch, Python, Node.js.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Backend Engineer - Meridian Platform (2024-2026)

- Owned the Node.js event pipeline processing 7M events/day.
- Introduced Terraform-managed infrastructure, cutting provisioning time by 47%.
- Designed internal Distributed systems standards used by 31+ downstream services.

Staff Backend Engineer - Timberline Technologies (2021-2024)

- Applied distributed-systems patterns to scale the platform to 310K concurrent users.
- Led migration of core services at Timberline Technologies onto Node.js, improving uptime during peak load.
- Designed a REST API design-backed data layer that cut p99 query latency by 52%.

Senior Backend Engineer - Ashgrove Networks (2010-2021)

- Built and maintained REST APIs in Elasticsearch serving 876K requests/day.
- Introduced Terraform-managed infrastructure, cutting provisioning time by 41%.
- Designed a PostgreSQL-backed data layer that cut p99 query latency by 30%.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Engineering, Boston University, 2010

SKILLS

- Elasticsearch
- Python
- Node.js
- PostgreSQL
- AWS
- Go
- Kafka
- System design
- Distributed systems
- REST API design
- Terraform
- TypeScript